INCH-POUND

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DETAIL SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, IMPULSE, MARK 44 MOD 0

This document remains inactive for new design.

This specification is approved for use by the Naval Surface Warfare Center Indian Head Division (NSWC IHD) and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Departments of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for the Mark 44 Mod 0 Impulse Cartridge (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATIONS

MIL-D-21625 - Design and Evaluation of Cartridges for Cartridge Actuated Devices

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARDS

MIL-STD-810 - Environmental Engineering Considerations and Laboratory Tests

MIL-STD-1168 - Ammunition Lot Numbering and Ammunition Data Card

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.)

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to Commander, Naval Sea Systems Command, ATTN: SEA 05S, 1333 Isaac Hull Avenue, SE, Stop 5160, Washington Navy Yard, DC 20376-5160 or emailed to CommandStandards@navy.mil, with the subject line "Document Comment". Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

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2.2.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

NAVAL AIR SYSTEMS COMMAND (NAVAIR) DRAWINGS

2240764	-	Body and Bridgewire Assembly
2240772	-	Cartridge, Impulse, Mk 44 Mod 0 Assembly
2406487	-	Primer Mix No. 487
2519737	-	Test Set, Closed Bomb
838AS102	-	Powder, Smokeless

(Copies of these documents are available from Commander, Indian Head Division, Naval Surface Warfare Center, CAD/PAD Data Management Branch [Code E26], 4393 Benson Road, BLDG 1557, Indian Head, MD 20640-5092. Refer questions, inquires, or problems to nswc_iheodtd_dmo@navy.mil.)

2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

ASTM INTERNATIONAL

ASTM E748	-	Standard Guide for Thermal Neutron Radiography of Materials
ASTM E1742/E1742M	-	Standard Practice for Radiographic Examination

(Copies of these documents are available online at www.astm.org.)

2.4 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in the contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.3) in accordance with 4.2.1. As specified (see 6.2), a first article inspection is required if 2 or more years have passed since the cartridge was manufactured, after major turnover in personnel, following major changes to the production facility, or following transfer of production to a new facility or site.

3.2 Design and construction. The Mark 44 Mod 0 cartridge shall be manufactured in accordance with Drawing 2240772.

3.3 Materials. All materials used in the manufacture of the cartridges shall be in accordance with the respective Naval Air Systems Command drawings unless specific approval in writing covering a departure therefrom has been obtained by the Technical Authority (see 6.6) prior to manufacture (see 6.2).

3.4 Primary components. For the purposes of this specification, the primer mix and the propellant charge are considered primary components. Only primary components from a single lot shall be used in a production lot of cartridges; however, one primary component production lot may be used in more than one cartridge production lot.

3.4.1 Primer mix. The primer mix shall be compounded and loaded in accordance with Drawings 2406487 and 2240772, respectively.

3.4.2 Propellant charge (smokeless powder). The propellant charge (smokeless powder) shall be manufactured in accordance with Drawing 838AS102.

3.4.2.1 Condition. There shall be no evidence of decomposition of the smokeless powder (see 4.3.2.1).

3.4.2.2 Quantity. All propellant charges shall be as specified on Drawing 2240772. Charges shall be determined by weight rather than by volume measurements.

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3.4.2.3 Handling and loading. The smokeless powder shall be subjected to no unnecessary handling or exposure to the atmosphere. The handling and loading of smokeless powder exposed to the atmosphere shall be performed only under conditions that do not permit the relative humidity to exceed 75 percent.

3.5 Cartridge requirements.

3.5.1 Insulation resistance. Prior to welding the bridgewires to the pins, the insulation resistance between the metal parts of the assemblies shall be a minimum of 50 megohms at a relative humidity of 80 percent or less when measured as specified in 4.3.1.

3.5.2 Visual inspection requirements. Cartridges shall be free of the following defects when inspected as specified in 4.3.2: illegible, missing, or inaccurate identification markings, incomplete threads, perforated closure disc, incomplete or improper welding of closure disc, bent pins, damaged O-rings, deep scratches, dents, sharp edges, burrs, or other defects which may prevent entry of the cartridge into the firing chamber or affect the resistance of the cartridge to moisture. Each cartridge shall meet the requirements of 3.4, 3.7, and Drawing 2240772.

3.5.3 Radiographic inspection requirements. When radiographically inspected as specified in 4.3.3, each cartridge shall show proper assembly, presence of parts, proper welding, sealing and proper electrical connections, proper thread form, presence of the propellant, no foreign materials, and proper assembly of pyrotechnic/non-metallic materials.

3.5.4 Bridge circuit resistance. The resistance of each of the two bridge circuits in each completely assembled cartridge, when measured electrically as specified in 4.3.4, shall be 0.30±0.05 ohms.

3.5.5 Leakage. The cartridge shall pass the dry gas leak test as specified in 4.3.5. Cartridges that exhibit a leak rate in excess of $1x10^{-5}$ cm^3 per second of air at a pressure differential of 1±0.1 atmospheres shall be considered defective.

3.6 Cartridge performance. Cartridges shall be capable of meeting all requirements of 3.6.1 through 3.6.7.

3.6.1 Power current. The cartridge shall not fire when subjected to the power current test specified in 4.3.6.

3.6.2 Static discharge. The cartridge shall not fire when the static discharge test is applied as specified in 4.3.7.

3.6.3 Stray voltage. The cartridge shall not fire when a stray voltage of 100 milliamperes is applied as specified in 4.3.8.

3.6.4 Shock. The cartridge shall not incur damage nor deformation when subjected to the shock test specified in 4.3.9.

3.6.5 Vibration. The cartridge shall not incur damage nor deformation when subjected to the vibration test specified in 4.3.10.

3.6.6 Temperature and humidity cycling. The cartridge shall not incur damage nor deformation when subjected to the temperature and humidity cycling specified in 4.3.11.

3.6.7 Ballistic requirements. The cartridge shall meet the requirements of 3.6.7.1 through 3.6.7.3 when subjected to the test specified in 4.3.12.

3.6.7.1 Hangfire. The cartridge shall fire within 75 milliseconds of the application of 5.0±0.10 amperes to each of the bridge circuits (10 amperes total current).

3.6.7.2 Maximum pressure. The maximum pressure produced by the cartridge shall be between 1,050 and 1,900 psig.

3.6.7.3 Misfire. There shall be no misfires.

3.7 Workmanship. Cartridges shall be constructed and finished in a manner to ensure compliance with all requirements of this specification.

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4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.2.1)

b. Production inspection (see 4.2.2)

c. Lot acceptance inspection (see 4.2.3)

4.2 Inspections.

4.2.1 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed on a sample of 64 cartridges when a first article sample is required (see 3.1). This inspection shall include the examinations and tests specified in table I. Sixty of these cartridges shall be expended in the tests listed in table I and four cartridges shall be retained for investigative purposes. Any damage inflicted by the environmental treatments that would adversely affect the performance of the item in the service application shall be cause for rejection of the first article sample. Failure of any cartridge to comply with the requirements of table I shall be cause for rejection of the first article represented.

TABLE I. First article inspection.

Tests	Requirement Paragraph	Test Paragraph	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
Insulation resistance	3.5.1	4.3.1	4	12	12	12	6	6	12
Visual inspection	3.4, 3.5.2, 3.7	4.3.2	4	12	12	12	6	6	12
Radiographic inspection	3.5.3	4.3.3	4	12	12	12	6	6	12
Bridge circuit resistance	3.5.4	4.3.4	4	12	12	12	6	6	12
Leakage	3.5.5	4.3.5	4	12	12	12	6	6	12
Power current 1/	3.6.1	4.3.6	4						
Static discharge 1/	3.6.2	4.3.7	4						
Stray voltage 1/	3.6.3	4.3.8	4						
Shock 2/	3.6.4	4.3.9					6		
Vibration 2/	3.6.5	4.3.10						6	
Temperature and humidity cycling 1/	3.6.6	4.3.11							12
Ballistic test -65 °F 70 °F 160 °F	3.6.7	4.3.12		12	12	12	6	6	12

NOTES:

1/ A bridge circuit resistance test shall be conducted following the specified test for information only.

2/ A visual inspection, bridge circuit resistance test, leakage test, and radiographic inspection shall be conducted following the specified test for information only.

4.2.2 Production inspection. All production cartridges shall be inspected and screened for the defects specified in table II. Cartridges failing to meet the requirements specified in table II, 3.2, and 3.3 shall be rejected and removed from the lot.

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TABLE II. Production inspection.

Tests	Requirement Paragraph	Test Paragraph
Insulation resistance	3.5.1	4.3.1
Visual inspection	3.4, 3.5.2, 3.7	4.3.2
Radiographic inspection	3.5.3	4.3.3
Bridge circuit resistance	3.5.4	4.3.4
Leakage	3.5.5	4.3.5

4.2.3 Lot acceptance inspection. Lot acceptance inspection shall consist of the examinations and tests specified in table III. Failure of any sample cartridge to comply with the requirements listed in table III shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented. Packaging defects shall be corrected before acceptance.

TABLE III. Lot acceptance inspection.

Tests	Requirement Paragraph	Test Paragraph	Quantity
Visual inspection	3.4, 3.5.2, 3.7	4.3.2	Test and retain sample
Radiographic inspection	3.5.3	4.3.3	Test and retain sample
Bridge circuit resistance	3.5.4	4.3.4	Test and retain sample
Leakage	3.5.5	4.3.5	Test and retain sample
Ballistic	3.6.7	4.3.12	Test sample

4.2.3.1 Sample size. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a random sample from each production lot, including the retained sample for investigative purposes, shall be selected in accordance with table IV for lot acceptance inspection.

TABLE IV. Lot acceptance sampling.

Lot Size	Ballistic Test Sample Size	Retain Sample Size	Total Sample Size
111 to 180	15	2	17
181 to 300	20	2	22
301 to 500	25	2	27
501 to 800	30	2	32
801 to 1,300	35	2	37
1,301 to 3,200	40	2	42

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4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 Insulation resistance. Prior to welding the bridgewires to the pins, to the complete body, and to the bridgewire assemblies (Drawing 2240764), the insulation resistance between the pins themselves, as well as between the pins and the cartridge body, shall be checked with an applied voltage of 500±25 volts direct current for 60 seconds. Each cartridge shall meet the requirements of 3.5.1. A leakage current that exceeds 0.1 milliamperes shall be cause for rejection.

4.3.2 Visual inspections.

4.3.2.1 Primary component inspection. The primer mix shall be visually inspected during compounding and loading for conformance to 3.4.1. The propellant charge shall be inspected for conformance to 3.4.2.1. Evidence of decomposition shall be cause for rejection. The charge quantity shall be measured for conformance to 3.4.2.2.

4.3.2.2 Cartridge inspection. The external condition and appearance of the cartridges shall be determined by comparison to Drawing 2240772. Specific inspections of the electrical connector, electrical shielding cap, threads, stainless steel case, output closure, weld, and identification label shall be conducted as a minimum. Each cartridge shall meet the requirements of 3.5.2.

4.3.3 Radiographic examination. Units shall be radiographically examined in accordance with ASTM E1742/E1742M and ASTM E748. Each cartridge shall be positioned for the most revealing exposure with the long axis perpendicular to the radiographic beam. One radiographic plate shall contain one identified inert cartridge to be used as a comparison aid. The inert cartridge shall be separated from the remaining cartridges on the plate. All cartridges shall be identified with serial numbers prior to examination. The cartridges shall be arranged on boards or trays in consecutive order with any missing serial numbers identified on the radiographic plate. Each radiograph shall carry a permanent identification of the items displayed thereon in a 4x6-inch region maximum. The radiographic identification shall include the drawing number, the complete lot number in accordance with MIL-STD-1168, the contract number, and the span of serial numbers displayed. Radiographs of the entire production lot shall accompany the ballistic sample to the activity conducting the tests. Any observable imperfections as outlined in 3.5.3 shall be cause for rejection of the cartridge. Defective cartridges found during radiographic review are to be marked on the radiographic plate and removed from the production lot.

4.3.4 Bridge circuit resistance. Conformance with the bridge circuit resistance of 3.5.4 shall be ascertained by means of a test circuit that limits the bridge current to a maximum of 25 milliamperes. The test circuit shall be connected to the cartridge through a fully assembled electrical connector, Bendix PC06E-8-4S or equivalent. A new connector shall be used after a maximum of 500 connections. A bridge that is known to be accurate within 1 percent in the range of resistance specified shall be used to determine whether or not the requirement is being met. Units that fail to meet the requirements of 3.5.4 or fail to assemble completely, by hand, with the specified connector shall be rejected. The results of bridge circuit resistance measurements shall not be affected by resistance of the test circuit and connector.

4.3.5 Leakage. Each cartridge in the ballistic sample shall be leak tested in a dry gas leak tester. Cartridges that exhibit a leak rate in excess of $1x10^{-5}$ cm^3 per second of air at a pressure differential of 1±0.1 atmospheres shall be considered defective. This is an in-process inspection and requires 100 percent inspection of the lot. Each cartridge shall meet the requirements specified in 3.5.5 or shall be rejected.

4.3.6 Power current. Power current shall be evaluated by applying a direct current of no less than 1 ampere, supplying a minimum of 0.03 watt to all bridge circuits for a period of at least 5 minutes. The test current shall be regulated throughout the period of application to within 2 percent. The unit shall not fire during the performance of this test. Cartridges shall be conditioned at 70±5 °F for a period of 12 hours minimum and 24 hours maximum prior to testing. Each cartridge shall meet the requirements 3.6.1.

4.3.7 Static discharge. The cartridge shall be subjected to a static discharge test by being connected to a 500±5-percent picofarad capacitor charged to 25,000±500 volts and 5,000±5-percent ohm resistor connected in a 5-microhenry total inductance series circuit. The cartridge shall be subjected to the static discharge between the pins shorted together and the case. Failure of any cartridge to comply with the requirements of 3.6.2 shall be cause for rejection of the lot or first article. Cartridges shall be conditioned at 70±5 °F for a minimum of 4 hours prior to testing.

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4.3.8 Stray voltage. Stray voltage shall be evaluated by applying 100±5 milliamperes in 300±10-millisecond pulses at a rate of 2 pulses per second for a total of 2,000 pulses. Stray voltage shall be applied across each bridge circuit of the cartridge. Cartridges shall be conditioned at 70±5 °F for a minimum of 4 hours prior to testing. Each cartridge shall meet the requirements of 3.6.3.

4.3.9 Shock. The shock pulse shall be applied to the cartridge's mounting points in both directions along each of three mutually perpendicular axes, for a total of 18 shocks. This test shall be conducted in accordance with method 516, procedure I of MIL-STD-810. The shock pulse wave form shall be terminal peak sawtooth. The peak amplitude shall be 20g and the duration shall be 11 milliseconds. After being subjected to the shock test, the cartridges shall be test fired at 70 °F. Failure of any cartridge to comply with the requirements of 3.6.4 shall be cause for rejection of the lot or first article.

4.3.10 Vibration. The cartridge shall be subjected to vibration testing in accordance with MIL-STD-810, method 514.1-I, curve Z, except that: (1) there shall be no resonance search or dwell, and (2) the cycling period shall be divided equally at -65, 70, and 160 °F. After vibration testing has been completed, the cartridges shall be test fired at 70 °F. Failure of any cartridge to comply with the requirements of 3.6.5 shall be cause for rejection of the lot or first article.

4.3.11 Temperature and humidity cycling. The test shall be conducted in accordance with the temperature and humidity cycling test of MIL-D-21625. Failure of any cartridge to comply with the requirements of 3.6.6 shall be cause for rejection of the lot or first article.

4.3.12 Ballistic tests. Cartridges shall be selected from each production lot in accordance with 4.2. The sample of cartridges shall be equally divided for temperature conditioning at -65±5 °F, +70±5 °F, and +160±5 °F for at least 4 to 24 hours maximum. If the sample is not equally divisible by three, the remaining cartridge(s) shall be placed in the group that is to be conditioned at -65±5 °F. The cartridges shall be fired in the closed bomb test fixture, in accordance with Drawing 2519737, within 5 minutes of removal from temperature condition. If not fired within 5 minutes, the cartridge shall be returned to +70±5 °F for at least 4 hours and then reconditioned to original environment for at least 4 to 24 hours maximum. The cartridges shall be initiated by applying a current of 5.0±0.10 amperes to each bridge circuits (10 amperes total). The cartridges shall be fired with the collar installed. Instrumentation shall be used for each firing to record pressure versus time and the elapsed time between actuation of the ignition element and the start of pressure rise. The test chamber shall be thoroughly cleaned after each cartridge firing. The cartridges shall meet the requirements of 3.6.7.

4.3.12.1 Maximum pressure. The maximum pressure shall be measured at the point at which the pressure reaches its maximum in the test fixture. Any failure to reach maximum pressure in accordance with the requirements of 3.6.7.2 shall result in failure of the lot represented.

4.3.12.2 Hangfire. The time from application of current to the cartridge bridge circuits to the start of pressure rise shall be used to determine compliance with the requirement of 3.6.7.1.

4.3.12.3 Misfire. The failure of any cartridge to fire as specified in 3.6.7 shall result in rejection of the lot represented, unless such failure is plainly attributable to faulty test equipment or procedure.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When actual packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD or in-house contractor personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activities within the Military Service or Defense Agency, or within the military service's system commands. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The Mark 44 Mod 0 Impulse Cartridge is intended for use in a helicopter hoist cable cutter which severs a steel cable and releases its load during an emergency. The cartridge is also used in the destruct unit of a target drone. This impulse cartridge is only used in military aircrafts, and there is no commercial application.

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6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. When first article inspection required (see 3.1 and 6.3).

c. When alternate materials or methods of manufacture specified on the respective Naval Air Systems Command drawings are used, the bidders' selections must be stated in the proposal (see 3.3).

d. Test activity and production lot size if other than as specified (see 4.2.3.1).

e. Whether a radiographic sample plate is required.

f. Whether a production inspection report is required.

g. Packaging requirements (see 5.1 and 6.5).

h. Directions for shipping radiographs of entire lot along with ballistic sample to the activity conducting production lot acceptance tests.

i. The safety precaution requirements of DoD Manual 4145.26, "DoD Contractor's Safety Manual for Ammunition and Explosives", are applicable and should be specified in the contract as required by the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 23.3. NOTE: When this specification is used as part of the description of work to be accomplished by a Government activity, the safety requirements of NAVSEA OP 5, "Ammunition and Explosives Safety Ashore", are applicable.

j. Certification of conformance that all deliverables met requirements of section 3 of this specification.

6.3 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the contracting officer should provide specific guidance to offerors whether the items should be a preproduction sample, a first article sample, a first production item, a sample selected from the first production items, standard production item for the contractor's current inventory (see 3.1) and the number of items to be tested as specified in 4.2.1. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examination, approval of first article test results, and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or test, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract. Bidders should not submit alternate bids unless specifically requested to do so in the solicitation.

6.4 Loaded assembly hazard information.

DOD, DOT, NATO Hazard Classification	Class 1, Division 4
United Nation Serial Number	0276
Storage Compatibility Grouping	C
UN Proper Shipping Name	Cartridge, Power Device

6.5 Contract packaging and marking. The following packaging and marking requirements should be specified in the contract.

6.5.1 Preservation. Preservation should be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

6.5.1.1 Level A. Level A preservation should be used for all production lots for service use. Four cartridges should be preserved in an inner container in accordance with the drawing of LD537927.

6.5.1.2 Level C. When directed by the contracting activity, cartridges intended for expenditure in first article testing or production lot acceptance testing should be preserved in accordance with Method 10 of MIL-STD-2073-1 and 49 CFR 171-178.

6.5.2 Packing. Packing should be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

6.5.2.1 Level A. Level A packing should be used for packing of all production lots for service use. Twelve inner containers, preserved as described in 6.5.1.1, should be packed in accordance with the drawings of LD537928.

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6.5.2.2 Level C. When directed by the contracting activity, cartridges intended for expenditure in first article testing or production lot acceptance testing, should be preserved as described in 6.5.1.2 and packed to afford protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use. Shipping containers should be in accordance with 49 CFR 171-178.

6.5.3 Marking.

6.5.3.1 Special marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order (see 6.2), marking of exterior containers should be in accordance with 49 CFR 171-178.

6.5.3.2 Normal marking. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the marking information on unit packs should be as specified on LD537927 and the marking information on shipping containers should be as specified on LD537928. The specified marking information should be applied to the containers in accordance with the applicable provisions of MIL-STD-129.

6.6 Technical Authority. The Technical Authority has the authority, responsibility, and accountability to establish, monitor, and approve technical standards, tools, and processes in conformance to higher authority policy, requirements, architectures, and standards. NAVSEA 05S may be contacted to determine the appropriate Technical Authority for any given requirement related to equipment and systems of U.S. Navy ships and submarines.

6.7 Subject term (key word) listing.

Cable cutter
Ordnance
Target drone

6.8 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Preparing activity:
Navy – OS
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